

Chicken Orzo (or Rice) Soup (Makes 8 cups)

Ida Farat

1 Tablespoon Mazola

1 lb chicken breasts (either with skins and bones or boneless skinless or 4 chicken thighs with or without skin and bones)

32 oz carton Chicken Broth

32 oz carton Chicken Stock

32 oz water

4 Wylers Chicken Boullion Cubes

1 large onion, whole

3 celery ribs cut in thirds

6 carrots diced in circles (or about 1 cup)

1 cup of cooked orzo (or 1 cup of cooked Uncle Ben's Long grain white rice)

1 teaspoon of Salt

¼ teaspoon of Pepper

¼ teaspoon of Allspice

Two Cinnamon sticks

In a separate pan, bring 2 cups of water to a boil. Add orzo (or rice). Bring water and orzo or rice to a boil. Lower heat to simmer setting. Cover pan and simmer orzo for 10 minutes or rice for 20 minutes. Remove cover and use fork to separate orzo or rice. Add to soup for last 10 minutes of cooking time.

In a 5-quart stock pot, heat Mazola and sauté chicken breasts or thighs until pink is removed from chicken on all sides if boneless skinless, or until skin is light golden brown and all sides have pink removed. Skim any fat from broth if necessary. Add whole onion and celery and cook until onion is light golden brown and celery is slightly tender.

Cover chicken and onion and celery with chicken broth, stock, water, and chicken bouillon cubes. Heat liquids with chicken to boiling. Add diced carrots and continue boiling for 10 minutes. Then lower heat to medium low and cook for 45 minutes (until chicken is cooked through and if used, skin and bones separate easily from the chicken meat). Add spices after 45 minutes and simmer for another 20 minutes.

After 20 minutes, strain out onion, tender celery, and cinnamon sticks. Remove chicken to separate skins and bones from chicken if used and break cooked chicken into pieces. Add chicken pieces and orzo or rice back into broth. Cook for five more minutes. Taste to adjust seasoning.